

JIYOUNG KIM

McGill University, Department of Economics
Leacock Building, 855 Sherbrooke St. West, Montreal, QC H3A 2T7, Canada
✉ jiyoung.kim4@mail.mcgill.ca 🌐 [website](#)

Placement Directors

Prof. Rui Castro	rui.castro@mcgill.ca	(514) 398-1226
Prof. Kensuke Sakamoto	kensuke.sakamoto@mcgill.ca	

Education

Ph.D. Economics <i>expected 2027</i>	McGill University <i>Fall 2021–</i>
M.A. Economics	Yonsei University <i>Mar 2019–Feb 2021</i>
B.A. Quantitative Risk Management and Economics	Yonsei University <i>Mar 2014–Aug 2018</i>

Fields of Specialization

Primary: Macroeconomics
Secondary: Labor Economics

Dissertation

Firm-level Workforce Composition and Firm Dynamics
Supervisors: Prof. Rui Castro, Prof. Markus Poschke

Job Market Paper

“Firm-level Workforce Composition and Firm Dynamics”

Abstract.

Using Canadian employer–employee matched data, this paper shows the importance of workforce quality for firms’ productivity and performance. By looking at how firms adjust their workforce composition over the life-cycle, I document how initial workforce quality shapes a firm’s future. Firms start with a small but high-quality workforce, then expand with lower-quality workers, diluting workforce quality. While firms share this trend, longer surviving firms maintain a better workforce than those that exit earlier. To explain the findings, I develop a firm dynamics model with endogenous productivity growth and choice over the mix of heterogeneous workers. Among the workers, only some high-quality workers, ‘leaders’, have the capability to build organizational capital, an intangible asset that raises productivity. As firms enter with little organizational capital, leaders are most needed when firms are young. Once enough organizational capital is accumulated, firms scale up with the lower-quality ‘regular workers’, who produce based on the foundation the leaders have laid. I use the calibrated model to quantify the importance of leaders for the aggregate economy. I find that a 1% increase in the wage of leaders lowers long-run aggregate productivity by 0.6%. The wage increase hits young firms hardest, depriving them of the opportunity to accumulate organizational capital. The forgone initial accumulation compounds into a permanent loss in firm-level productivity and accounts for 80% of the long-run aggregate productivity loss.

Other Research Papers

- **“Predicting Labor Force Types”** [🔗](#), NBER Working Paper No. 35295, with Castro, Lange, Larivière and Poschke
- **“Labour Force Histories”**, work in progress, with Castro, Lange, and Poschke

Teaching Experience

- Teaching Assistant, Econ 354: Macroeconomics — Honours 2, McGill University 2026 W
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 450: Advanced Economic Theory 1 [🔗](#), McGill University 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026 W; 2026 F
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 713: Macroeconomic Theory 2, McGill University 2025 W
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 209: Macroeconomic Analysis & Applications [🔗](#), McGill University 2025 Summer, 2025 F
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 332: Macroeconomic Theory — Majors 1 [🔗](#), McGill University 2024 F
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 208: Microeconomic Analysis & Applications [🔗](#), McGill University 2022 F

Research and Relevant Work Experience

Research Assistant
Knowledge Sharing Program (KSP)

Korea Development Institute (KDI)
Aug 2014–Apr 2016

- Policy consultation for the Government of Belize on a national science, technology and innovation strategy
- Project report

Conference and Seminar Presentations

- 2026
- CIREQ Lunch Seminar, McGill University, Aug
T2M Student Workshop Program, HEC Montreal, June
Canadian Economics Association, Simon Fraser University, May
20th CIREQ–CIRANO PhD Students’ Conference, CIRANO Montreal, May
19th QICSS Emerging Excellence Conference, INRS, Apr
- 2025
- CIREQ Lunch Seminar, McGill University, Nov
- 2024
- Canadian Economics Association, Toronto Metropolitan University, May

Rewards and Grants

- 2021–2026
- Graduate Excellence Award, McGill University
- 2026
- Best Presentation Award, 19th QICSS Emerging Excellence Conference, INRS
- 2017
- High Honors, Yonsei University

Languages

Korean (native), English (fluent), Spanish (advanced)

Computational Skills

Python, MATLAB, Stata, TensorFlow, Keras

References

Prof. Rui Castro	McGill University	rui.castro@mcgill.ca	(514) 398-1226
Prof. Markus Poschke	McGill University	markus.poschke@mcgill.ca	(514) 398-1233